

Rodrigo Alonso Jorquera Díaz

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SUMMARY

Computer Engineering student (4th year) at Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile (PUC), focused on Data Science, Machine Learning, LLMs, and AI. Global Winner of the EY AI & Data Challenge 2026 (water quality prediction model for South African rivers, ~45,000 participants). Teaching Assistant for Advanced Programming (IIC2233). Active member of the student initiative Ingeniería para Chile, applying technology to real needs in local communities and municipalities.

EDUCATION

B.S. in Engineering, Major in Computer Science

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

2023 – Present

EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

July 2025 – Present

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

- Teaching Assistant (grader) for Advanced Programming (IIC2233), responsible for grading assignments and written exams.
- Ran and tested student-submitted code, verifying functional correctness and identifying design flaws.
- Provided detailed technical feedback to promote good programming practices (readability, modularity, error handling).

Student Initiative – Ingeniería para Chile

March 2025 – Present

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

- **CLIC Committee (Computing and IT Lab for Communities)**
 - * Developed a website for the Municipal Public Works Department (DOM) of El Bosque, focused on data visualization through an interactive map with per-department layers.
 - * Built the initiative's own website for Ingeniería para Chile.
 - * Contributing to a project for the Disaster Risk Management Department (DGRD) of Ñuñoa Municipality (ongoing).
- **Outreach Committee**
 - * Produced and edited video content and designed graphics for social media.
 - * Supported the development of the initiative's visual identity (logos, brand guidelines) in Figma.
 - * Helped promote events and represented the initiative at student fairs.

Intern

July 2025 – August 2025

Puente Alto Municipality

- Interned at the Municipal Planning Secretariat (SECPLA), conducting a survey of participatory paving projects across the municipality.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES & ACHIEVEMENTS

Global Winner | EY AI & Data Challenge 2026

2026

- 1st place globally out of ~45,000 participants, with a water quality prediction model for South African rivers (final score: 0.8109 R^2).
- Migrated the winning solution to Snowflake after the competition; awarded an invitation to Snowflake Summit 2026 (San Francisco, CA) to present the solution on a panel.

GCI World | Matsuo-Iwasawa Lab, University of Tokyo

2026 (ongoing)

- Selected for the global AI/Data Science program run by the Matsuo-Iwasawa Lab (supported by JICA); covering supervised/unsupervised ML, time series, and feature engineering.

SKILLS

Machine Learning / Data Science:

- XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Optuna (Bayesian hyperparameter tuning), scikit-learn
- Spatial/temporal validation (GroupKFold, StratifiedGroupKFold), feature engineering
- Deep Learning (PyTorch), local LLM tooling (Ollama, LM Studio)

Programming:

- **Python (advanced):** OOP, threading, GUI development (PyQt)
- **SQL (intermediate)**
- **JavaScript / React (intermediate)**
- **C (intermediate)**
- **VHDL (intermediate)**
- **PHP (intermediate)**
- **HTML / CSS (intermediate)**
- **R (basic)**

Software:

- PowerPoint
- Figma
- Excel

Languages:

- Spanish: Native
- English: Intermediate